Case Study: Phishing

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers impersonate trusted entities to steal sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, or personal data. A realistic scenario involves a college student receiving an email that appears to be from their university administration, warning that their account will be suspended unless they verify their login details.

The attack typically happens step-by-step: first, the attacker sends a convincing email or message with official logos and language. Next, the message includes a link to a fake website that closely resembles the real one. The victim, believing it to be legitimate, clicks the link and enters their credentials. These details are then captured by the attacker, who can access the victim's accounts or misuse the information for financial or identity-related fraud.

Phishing commonly targets students, employees, and individuals who frequently use online services. The consequences include unauthorized access to accounts, financial loss, identity theft, and potential misuse of personal data.

This situation could be prevented by carefully checking email addresses, avoiding suspicious links, and enabling two-factor authentication. Being cautious and aware is essential to protect oneself from phishing attacks.

Stay Safe Online

pUse strong, unique passwords and enable two-factor authentication (2FA)
Do not click on suspicious links or messages from unknown sources
Always verify the sender before sharing personal or login information
Avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking or sensitive activities
Keep your apps and devices updated regularly
Never share your UPI PIN or OTP with anyone
Check payment requests carefully before approving on apps like Google Pay or PhonePe
Be cautious about what you share on social media
Report cybercrime at National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or call Helpline 1930